quantum gravity emerge from these discussions, as the meaning of these solutions of the Wheeler–DeWitt equation gradually clarify. Upon these solutions, little by little, a coherent theory begins to be erected, inheriting the name ‘loop theory’ from the first solutions studied.

Today there are hundreds of scientists working on this theory, spread throughout the world from China to Argentina, from Indonesia to the United States. What is slowly being erected is the theory now known as loop theory, or loop quantum gravity: the theory to which the following chapters are devoted. It is not the only direction explored in the search for a quantum theory of gravity, but it is the one I consider the most promising.[fn33]